

TOPIC 5: INTRODUCTION TO TAJWID

1. Meaning of Tajwid

The word **Tajwid** comes from the Arabic root *jawwada*, which means '**to make better**' or '**to improve**'. In Islamic terminology, Tajwid is the science of reciting the Qur'an correctly by giving every letter its due right in terms of pronunciation, characteristics, and rules.

Simply put: **Tajwid is the correct way of reading the Qur'an as it was revealed to Prophet Muhammad (peace be upon him).**

2. Importance of Tajwid

- It preserves the original pronunciation and meaning of the Qur'an.
- Incorrect recitation can change the meaning of words and verses.
- It is a way of honouring the words of Allah.
- The Prophet (peace be upon him) said the one who recites the Qur'an skilfully will be with the noble angels.
- Learning Tajwid is an obligation (Fard) on every Muslim who recites the Qur'an.
- It helps in beautifying the recitation and increasing concentration in prayer.

3. Rules of Pronunciation and Fluency

Tajwid involves several key areas:

a) Makharij al-Huruf (Points of Articulation):

Knowing the correct place in the mouth, throat, or lips from which each letter is pronounced. There are 17 main points of articulation.

b) Sifat al-Huruf (Characteristics of Letters):

Each letter has unique qualities such as strength (shiddah), softness (rikhwah), elevation (isti'la), lowering (istifal), etc.

c) Rules of Noon Sakinah, Tanwin, Meem Sakinah, and Madd (elongation):

These are special rules that govern how certain letters are pronounced when they meet other letters.

4. Common Errors in Recitation

Students should avoid the following common mistakes:

- Changing one letter into another (e.g., saying 'seen' instead of 'saad').
- Not observing the correct length of Madd (elongation).
- Ignoring the rules of Noon Sakinah and Tanwin (Izhar, Idgham, Ikhfa, Iqlab).
- Not pronouncing heavy letters (Tafkhim) correctly.
- Stopping in the middle of a word or at the wrong place (incorrect Waqf).
- Reading too fast without proper clarity.

5. How to Improve Tajwid

- Learn from a qualified teacher (Sheikh or Ustaz) who has an Ijazah (authorization).
- Listen carefully to skilled reciters (Qaris) such as Sheikh Sudais, Minshawi, or Husary.
- Practise regularly and slowly, focusing on one rule at a time.
- Record your own recitation and compare it with a correct one.
- Memorize the rules and apply them consistently.

Summary

Tajwid is the science of correct Qur'anic recitation. It protects the meaning of the Qur'an, beautifies the reading, and is an important duty for every Muslim. By learning the points of articulation, letter characteristics, and special rules, and by avoiding common errors, a student can recite the Qur'an properly as it was revealed.

End of Topic 5 – Introduction to Tajwid